ALMS CONTROL

- **For some, begging more habit than need. Indore has beggars with bank savings, luxury travel and housing**
- **Cash rewards encourage citizens to report beggars and almsgivers alike**
- **3,500 beggars counselled, 470 rehabilitated by Dec. 2024. The Indore model sets blueprint for nationwide adoption**

Singh issued prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nyay Sanhita (BNS), under which beggars and almsgivers can be booked and face up to six months in jail. Citizens who report beggars or those giving alms can earn a cash reward of Rs 1,000. "A total of Rs 25,000 has been given out by the administration as reward in the first two weeks of the order being promulgated," says Mishra.

Begging or promoting begging is a crime under the state's Bhikshavriti Nishedh (Sanshodhan) Adhiniyam, 2018, originally a 1973 legislation. "There were many complaints from citizens and the police that begging had become a menace and was linked to crimes, especially those involving drugs and child labour. Begging is also to be stopped under the central government's SMILE [Support for Marginalised Individuals for Livelihood and Enterprise] programme," says Singh.

The exact number of the transient beggar population in Indore is difficult to come by. But the programme has reportedly made significant progress with widespread public support, setting a new standard for urban social reform. ■

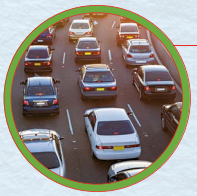
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12 Mn Registered Vehicles in a Population of 14 Mn in Bengaluru

Bengaluru's pollution is on the rise!





Time lost in traffic 117 hours per year

Rampant encroachment on lakes



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